regard for academic institutions and reverence for excel ent academicians. I value the inputs that academicians can make to development. Formal requests had been placed with these institutions and arrangements arrived at under which expertise from their faculties would be extended to DRDL in pursuance of its projects.

Let me highlight a few contributions of academic institutions to the various missile systems. Prithvi had been designed as an inertial y guided missile. To reach the target accurately, the trajectory parameters have to be loaded into its brain—an on-board computer. A team of young engineering graduates at Jadavpur University under the guidance of Prof. Ghoshal developed the required robust guidance algorithm. At the I Sc, postgraduate students under the leadership of Prof. IG Sharma developed air defence software for multi-target acquisition by Akash. The re- entry vehicle system design methodology for Agni was developed by a young team at I T Madras and DRDO scientists. Osmania University's Navigational Electronics Research and Training Unit had developed stateof-the-art signal processing algorithms for Nag. I have only given a few examples of col aborative endeavour. In